

"99.9% of science is boring."
- Makise Kurisu

PRECALCULUS

July 28, 2026

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CONTENTS

1	Functions	1
1.1	Intro To Functions	1
1.2	Evaluating Functions	3
1.2.1	Difference Quotient	4
1.3	Finding Domains	5
1.3.1	The Problem Areas	5
1.4	Operations Of Functions	7
1.5	The Vertical Line Test	8
1.6	Features of Graphs Points, Domain, Range	9
1.7	Properties of Functions: Even or Odd	11
1.8	Properties of Functions: Increasing or Decreasing	13
1.9	Properties of Functions: Extremas	15
1.10	Average Rate of Change	16
1.11	Piece-wise Functions	17
1.12	Important Functions	19
2	Graphical Transformations	22
2.1	Introduction To Graphical Transformations	22
2.1.1	Vertical	22
2.1.2	Horizontal	22
2.1.3	Vertical Stretch/Compression	24
2.1.4	Horizontal Stretch/Compression	24
2.1.5	Reflection	25
2.2	How to Graph with Transformations	27
3	Quadratics	29
3.1	Intro to Solving Quadratics	29
3.1.1	Cases	29
3.2	The Square Root Method for Quadratics	31
3.3	Factoring Method for Quadratics	33
3.4	Completing the Square Method for Quadratics	36
3.5	Proving the Quadratic Formula	39
3.5.1	Proof	39
3.6	The Quadratic Formula	40
3.7	Graphs of Quadratics	42

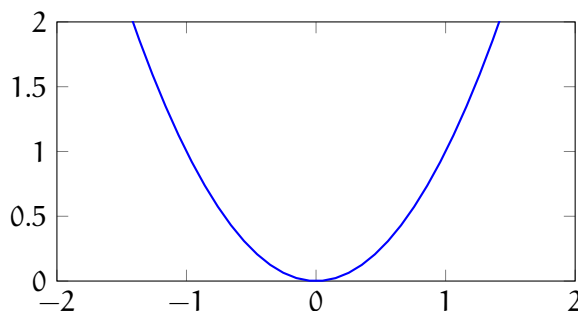
4	Intersection of Functions	42
5	Solving Equations by Using Substitutions	44

3.7 Graphs of Quadratics

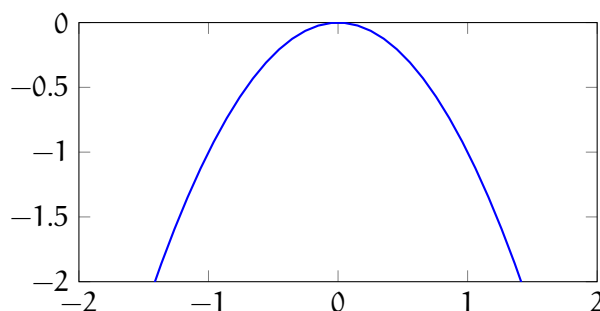
Definition 3.8 (Graphing Quadratics). The process of drawin a U-shaped curve called a *parabola* on a grid based on an equation where the highest power of the variable is 2 ($f(x) = ax^2 + bx + c$).

Note: The graph will always look like if a is.

1. if $a > 0$ it becomes an upward opening parabola.



2. if $a < 0$ it becomes a downward opening parabola.



Definition 3.9 (y Intercept). The point where the graph (a U-shaped curve called a parabola) crosses the vertical y-axis, always occuring where $x = 0$. The y-intercept is simply the constant number c .

$$(0, c)$$

Definition 3.10 (x Intercept). A point where the graph (a U-shaped curve called a parabola) crosses the horizontal x-axis.

$$ax^2 + bx + c = 0$$

Definition 3.11 (Vertex). The turning point on a parabola's U-shaped graph where the function reaches its maximum or minimum value, and the graph changes direction.

$$\left(\frac{b}{2a}, f(x) \right)$$

Or we can complete the square for the vertex form.

Example 3.11 (Quadratics Graphs).

1. $f(x) = 2x^2 + 8x + 5$

(a) Vertex:

$$\left(-\frac{(8)}{2(2)}, \right)$$

Note: We plug in -2 into the function.

$$(-2, -3)$$

(b) y-intercept:

$$(0, 5)$$

(c) x-intercept:

$$2x^2 + 8x + 5 = 0$$

$$x = \frac{-(8) \pm \sqrt{(8)^2 - 4(2)(5)}}{2(2)}$$

$$x = \frac{-8 \pm \sqrt{24}}{4}$$

$$x \approx -3.22 \wedge x \approx -0.77$$

